

India's defence exports more than double

India's defence exports have more than doubled to nearly ₹ 110 billion, on the back of recent policy liberalisation and access to the US market, given a large number of offsets being executed by domestic companies.

This increase in defence exports is expected to move up exponentially, with Rajnath Singh-led defence ministry going ahead with a new general export licence plan. It will enable Indian companies to export certain equipment to identified nations.

The biggest contributor to Indian exports has been the US, accounting for nearly ₹ 50 billion worth of exports, followed by old arms partners Israel and

the European Union. Officials have said that the increase in exports comes after recent changes in policy that have made it easier for companies to get official permissions, as per a leading daily.

A new plan for an Open General Export Licence, likely to be processed over the next few weeks, will give India further access to the global market as blanket permissions will be given for select items.

The ministry is looking to encourage private and public sectors to go beyond the export of components to platforms where large-scale value addition can be done. According to ministry data, most of the exports are for components, with parts for small arms topping the chart.

NITI Aayog to develop index that ranks AI adoption in India

National Institution for Transforming India (NITI) Aayog, which is the country's policy commission, is planning to develop an artificial intelligence (AI) readiness index. The index will rank Indian states on their ability to implement AI for the delivery of public services, adopt new AI applications and leverage AI's potential.

According to reports, the commission's AI index is one of several scales that rank health, education and agriculture in Indian states based on certain criteria. Although indicators for the

AI index are yet to be finalised, it could consider a state's initiatives on AI, digital skills among residents in the region, degree of innovation among existing startups as well as data capacity.

A government official has said that the commission, over the last few years, has been pushing for the adoption of AI, and the next natural step is to assess the outcomes of the states' initiatives on AI. The index will identify challenges for each state in the adoption of AI and recommend possible areas of improvement.

DoT to start identifying new spectrum bands for 5G networks in India

Department of Telecom (DoT) will start identifying and making available new spectrum bands for access and back-

haul segments, for timely deployment and growth of 5G networks, according to a ministry note. The department will

On The Move

Azim Premji hands over role of executive chairman to son Rishad A. Premji

Wipro's founder Azim Premji will retire as executive chairman and managing director of the company on July 30. Azim Premji's son, Rishad A. Premji will be reappointed as whole-time director as well as designated executive chairman of the company. Also, Abidali Z. Neemuchwala will be appointed as managing director of the company from July 31.

Satish Dhanasekaran appointed to Technological Advisory Council for Federal Communications Commission

Satish Dhanasekaran, senior vice president of Keysight Technologies Inc. and president of the company's Communications Solutions Group, has been appointed to Technological Advisory Council (TAC) for Federal Communications Commission (FCC). FCC is an independent US government agency that regulates communications within the US and internationally. TAC provides technical expertise to FCC on a variety of topics including 5G, broadband networks, spectrum, artificial intelligence (AI) and more. Dhanasekaran has been appointed for a two-year term on the council.

Berkshire Hathaway's Todd Combs to join Paytm board

Todd Combs, one of the top lieutenants of storied investor Warren Buffett at Berkshire Hathaway, will join the board of mobile payments major Paytm. Coming aboard with Combs on Paytm's board would be Yao Michael, senior vice president, head of corporate finance at Alibaba group. Michael would replace Joseph Tsai, founding member and executive vice chairman of Alibaba group, on the board.